Contrary to popular belief, India does not have one national language. The Constituent Assembly recognized a number of Indian languages and designated Hindi as an official language, along with English as a second official language until 1965. In 1967, the deadline for the use of English was extended.

SHANKARRAO DEO

1895–1974



Shankarrao Deo was a believer in Gandhi's ideas of non-violence, and an active member of the Congress and the Constituent Assembly, where he spoke eloquently on the issue of a 'national' language, arguing that India's diversity of languages and cultures must be respected. After Independence, he was a key member of the Samyukta Maharashtra Parishad, which sought a separate state for Marathi speakers with Bombay as its capital. But Bombay was a melting pot, and the large Gujarati community wanted the city to be the capital of their own state. It took years of protests, negotiations and violence for Maharashtra (with Bombay as its capital) to be finally created on 1 May 1960.

P SHILU AO

1916–1988